



Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Nigeria's new phone registry threatens rising smartphone prices** — TechCabal, 21 September 2026 NIGERIA

A feature on how the NCC's Device Management System, which requires every SIM-enabled phone to be registered by IMEI before sale or connection, could raise phone prices. Importers, traders and repair shops fear the validation fee and compliance costs will be passed to buyers. The NCC says the registry records device data but gives it no access to the contents of phones. *Also under [Access to services](#).*
- **Nigeria expanded broadband but missed its 70% penetration target** — BusinessDay NG, 21 September 2026 NIGERIA

Nigeria's National Broadband Plan 2020–2025 ended short of its main target: broadband penetration was 51.97% in December 2025 against 70%, according to NCC figures. 4G made up 52.95% of mobile subscriptions at the end of 2025, also short of its 70% target. The analysis traces penetration through the plan period, when it fell as low as 40.88% in 2021. *Also under [Connectivity](#).*
- **New Sita boss vows to rebuild trust after governance failures** — Business Day, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

An interview with Magatho Mello, managing director of South Africa's State Information Technology Agency since April and its first permanent head since late 2023. He wants to retire old systems, build shared platforms that serve several departments, and simplify tendering for start-ups. A ministerial report in July had set out governance and procurement failures at the agency over 2020–25. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*
- **Minister Solly Malatsi: National Digital Sovereignty Agenda** — South African Government (gov.za), 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Opening GovTech 2026 in Durban on 21 September 2026, South Africa's communications minister Solly Malatsi said government digital systems are still fragmented and that the first phase of the Digital Transformation Roadmap ends in February 2027. He presented digital sovereignty as a matter of development rather than security. He also said he had discussed with Operation Vulindlela and the Digital Council making the country a hub for submarine cables and digital infrastructure. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#), [Data Exchange](#) and [Connectivity](#).*
- **Kenya, Hoover Institution sign AI data pact** — ITWeb Africa, 21 September 2026 KENYA

Kenya's foreign ministry signed a five-year memorandum of understanding with the Emerging Markets Working Group at Stanford's Hoover Institution during the UN General Assembly in New York. The signing date was not given. The first project is an El Niño monitoring and response system that brings climate, geospatial, water, farming and infrastructure data together by county. Later work is to include a digital trade readiness index and a tracker for public-private partnerships. *Also under [AI](#).*

- **Governo quer acelerar transformação digital dos serviços públicos até 2029** — Agência de Informação de Moçambique (AIM), 21 September 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

Mozambique is drafting a three-year operational plan to speed up the digitisation of public services to 2029. At a meeting of the technical commission on digital transformation in Maputo on 21 September 2026, the head of the digital transformation agency said the Citizen Portal already offered about 26 services and had over 3,000 users before its official launch. An interoperability portal, a payments platform for state services, a government cloud and a government data centre are to follow. The commission expects to harmonise and cost the plan within two to three months, with funding spread across many donor projects. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#), [Data Exchange](#) and [Data Storage](#).*

- **Governo Garante “Soberania do Estado” Sobre Dados Públicos** — Diário Económico, 21 September 2026

MOZAMBIQUE

A second account of the Mozambique digital transformation meeting, summarised under the AIM report. It leads on the state administration minister, Inocêncio Impissa, saying that data produced by public bodies must belong to the state. The plan has not yet been costed. *Also under [Data Exchange](#) and [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*

- **Draft National Payment System Policy, August 2026** — The National Treasury, Republic of Kenya, 21 September 2026 KENYA

Kenya's draft National Payment System Policy, dated August 2026, which identifies ten gaps in the current system. It commits to a national instant payment switch, requires open APIs and gives non-banks access to settlement. The consultation is summarised under the Treasury and central bank's joint release. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

- **Draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill, 2026** — Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026 KENYA

Kenya's National Treasury and central bank published a draft National Payment System Policy and a draft National Payment System Bill, 2026 for public comment on 21 September 2026. The bill would replace the current Act and license payment providers and system operators by category, with minimum capital of Ksh5 million to Ksh250 million. It also requires interoperability, allows open-finance data sharing with consent and brings virtual asset providers that offer payments under the law, while the policy commits the government to a national instant payment switch. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [Legislation and regulation](#).*

- **Communiqué du Conseil des ministres** — Interfil Algérie, 21 September 2026

ALGERIA

Algeria's Council of Ministers, meeting under President Tebboune on 20 September 2026, called for a presidential decree setting up a secure plan for data exchange between state bodies, overseen by the High Commissioner for Digitalisation. The president asked for the plan to reach the wilayas too, with strong protection of citizens' data. He also ordered that payments to farmers at the state cereals office be digitised immediately. *Also under [Data Exchange](#).*

- **Bank of Sudan's banking sector reform strategy faces range of challenges, led by digital transformation - Dabanga Radio TV Online** — Radio Dabanga, 21 September 2026 SUDAN

An analysis of the Central Bank of Sudan's 2026–2030 strategic plan, published in December 2025, which includes speeding up digital transformation in the banking system. Banker Omar Sid Ahmed argues that with about 98% of the money supply outside the banks and branches lost to the war, the plan needs a 12-month emergency programme with budgets and measurable targets. He adds that digital projects depend on infrastructure that is not yet in place. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

Legislation and regulation

- **The National Payment System Bill, 2026 (draft for comment)** — The National Treasury / Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026 KENYA

The full draft text of Kenya's National Payment System Bill, 2026, which runs to 79 clauses. It sets licence capital of Ksh5 million to Ksh250 million, requires interoperability, provides for open finance, brings virtual asset providers into scope and sets fines of up to Ksh20 million. The consultation is summarised under the Treasury and central bank's joint release. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [Open data](#).*

- **Sicom 2026 : un bilan et des engagements pour l'avenir** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 21 September 2026

CONGO

Congo's first information, communication and media fair closed at Kintélé on 19 September 2026 with 23 resolutions from participants. They call for rewriting the three core media laws to take account of digital broadcasting, online platforms and AI, and cover digital content, advertising and tax. These are recommendations from the profession, not government decisions. *Also under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#) and [AI](#).*

- **MPs BACK E1.14BN DIGITAL LOANS - Eswatini Positive News** — Eswatini Positive News, 21 September 2026

ESWATINI

Eswatini MPs spoke in support of the three World Bank facilities, together worth US\$65 million (about E1.14 billion), that fund the Digital Eswatini Project, at the bills' second reading. The debate is summarised under the Eswatini Independent's report. *Also under [New investments](#), [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#), [Digital Identity and CRVS](#) and [Connectivity](#).*

- **Liberia's Cybercrime Law Faces Its First Real Trial as VP Koung case exposes Liberia's widening fault lines** — FrontPage Africa, 21 September 2026 LIBERIA

A second account of the Wrotto arrest, summarised under the New Dawn report. It adds a justice ministry prosecutor's view that the state, not the vice-president, decides whether a prosecution goes ahead, and notes that the Act does not mention AI or deepfakes. *Also under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#) and [Cybersecurity](#).*

- **Koung Seeks Release of AI Image Suspect** — The New Dawn Liberia, 21 September 2026 LIBERIA

Liberia's vice-president Jeremiah Koung asked for the release of Jerry Nyantee Wrotto, whom police detained under the Cybercrime Act over AI-made images and videos of Koung, and said he would not press charges. It is one of the first high-profile uses of the Act, signed on 19 August 2026 with the Data Protection Act. The head of the Executive Protection Service defended the arrest, while critics including former finance minister Samuel Tweah said the Act's cyberbullying clauses cover protected speech. *Also under [Cybersecurity](#) and [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).*

- **FPB plans AI-powered oversight of streaming, social platforms** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 September 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's Film and Publication Board has approved a strategy on digitisation and AI and plans to try generative AI for monitoring, classifying content and managing cases over the next three to five years. None of it is yet in use. Its enforcement committee fined 21 content distributors a total of R16.175 million in September 2026. *Also under [AI](#).*

- **Fintech will drive jobs, economic growth – Namfisa** — New Era, 21 September 2026

NAMIBIA

The head of Namibia's financial regulator, Kenneth Matomola, said fintech could help with jobs and financial inclusion now that the Financial Institutions and Markets Act and a new Namfisa Act are in force. Both took effect on 1 May 2026. He cited youth unemployment of 44.4% in the 2023 labour force survey. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#) and [Access to services](#).*

- **E455m EPTC loan puts taxpayers on the line** — Independent News Eswatini, 21 September 2026

ESWATINI

Eswatini's House of Assembly took the second reading of three bills on 21 September 2026 financing the US\$65 million World Bank Digital Eswatini Project. MPs focused on the US\$26 million (about E455 million) loan to the state telecoms company EPTC, which the government would guarantee. The finance minister said that loan pays for EPTC's financial stabilisation and a change in its pension scheme, repayable from 2034 to 2051; the other two facilities fund broadband to Tinkhundla centres, schools and clinics, online government services, digital ID, payments and skills training. The bills now go to committee. *Also under [New investments](#), [Other GovTech](#) and [e-Gov and Connectivity](#).*

- **Draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill, 2026** — Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026

KENYA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

Data protection

- **Mauritanie: le projet de restriction des réseaux sociaux aux plus jeunes suscite des réactions** — RFI, 21 September 2026

MAURITANIA

Reactions in Nouakchott to the government's plan, presented to cabinet on 16 September 2026, to bar under-16s from social media without parental consent. A blogger supports protecting children but fears the measure could be used to restrict free expression, and a cybersecurity expert argues for education rather than bans. *Also under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).*

Regional collaboration

- **Paula Ingabire Calls for Cross-Border Digital Systems to Accelerate Africa's Tech Transformation - Taarifa Rwanda:** — Taarifa Rwanda, 21 September 2026

RWANDA

Speaking in New York ahead of the UN General Assembly, Rwanda's ICT minister Paula Ingabire said African countries need digital systems that work across borders if they are to benefit from technology and AI. She argued that separate national systems limit how far data, services and businesses can move across the continent. *Also under [Data Exchange](#).*

- **LRA to Provide Technical Support for Gambia's Revenue Collection Dashboard** — Global News Network Liberia, 21 September 2026

GAMBIA

LIBERIA

The Liberia Revenue Authority signed a memorandum of engagement to help the Gambia Revenue Authority build a dashboard that tracks revenue collection; it was announced from Accra on 20 September 2026 and signed during meetings of the West African Tax Administration Forum. The help covers a review of GRA's data sources, choice of indicators, design, a prototype, integration and staff training. The LRA will send the developer of its own dashboard to Banjul for an initial three weeks. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*

- **GRA and Liberia Revenue Authority sign deal to deepen digital cooperation** — The Point, 21 September 2026

GAMBIA

LIBERIA

The Gambian account of the Liberia–Gambia revenue dashboard agreement, summarised under the GNN Liberia report. It adds that the LRA pays the expert's airfare while the GRA covers lodging and local transport. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*

- **EAC, PAPSS, IA : la BCC accélère l'intégration de la RDC dans l'écosystème financier africain** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026

DRC

DR Congo joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System on 18 September 2026, when the central bank governor, André Wameso, signed the accession agreement in Nairobi. The same day he signed the East African Community central banks' memorandum on currency convertibility and repatriation, which Burundi, Uganda, Tanzania, Kenya and South Sudan had already joined. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech and AI](#).*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **We co-led the UN's dialogue on safe and secure AI. Here's what needs to happen now** — Fortune, 21 September 2026

GLOBAL

An opinion piece by the two co-leads on safe and secure AI at the first UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance, held in Geneva in July. They ask the UN to take steps with no downside now: a formal link between its scientific panel on AI and the negotiations before next May, and a common safety baseline built on existing frameworks such as the OECD principles and the Hiroshima code. *Also under [AI](#).*

- **SIERRA LEONE'S NATIONAL AI STRATEGY SHOULD SET AUTHORITY LIMITS FOR AGENTS** — The Calabash Newspaper, 21 September 2026

SIERRA LEONE

An opinion column by Gleb Tspursky arguing that Sierra Leone's first national AI strategy, which the communications ministry is drafting with the World Bank, should limit what AI agents are allowed to do. He proposes minimum access rights, identities for machines, human approval before consequential actions, and testing before deployment. *Also under [AI](#).*

- **Evaluating Government Policies and Interventions in Advancing Digital Inclusion in Rural Nigeria - NALTF** — National Assembly Library Trust Fund, 21 September 2026

NIGERIA

A research summary from the National Assembly Library Trust Fund arguing that Nigeria's rural digital divide comes from weak funding, coordination and oversight, not from a lack of policy. It reviews the digital economy strategy, the 2020–2025 broadband plan, the Universal Service Provision Fund and the Digital Nigeria programme. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*

- **Sicom 2026 : un bilan et des engagements pour l'avenir** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 21 September 2026

CONGO

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

- **Mauritanie: le projet de restriction des réseaux sociaux aux plus jeunes suscite des réactions** — RFI, 21 September 2026 MAURITANIA
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- **Liberia's Cybercrime Law Faces Its First Real Trial as VP Koung case exposes Liberia's widening fault lines** — FrontPage Africa, 21 September 2026 LIBERIA
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).
- **Koung Seeks Release of AI Image Suspect** — The New Dawn Liberia, 21 September 2026 LIBERIA
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

- **Orange Egypt, Marakez pen partnership to deploy digital infrastructure across four developments** — ZAWYA, 21 September 2026 EGYPT
Orange Egypt will design, install and operate telecoms networks at four Marakez developments: Ramla, District 5, Aeon Towers and Mall of Arabia. The deal covers fibre to the home, bundled broadband, TV and voice, public Wi-Fi and a smart CCTV system for the mall's first phase. No value was disclosed. *Also under [Connectivity](#).*

New investments

- **VEA Capital Partners Backs Bonisa Applied Insights To Unlock Data-Driven Value Globally** — Africa Tech Summit, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
VEA Capital Partners, the investment arm of VEA Group, has bought a stake of undisclosed size in Bonisa Applied Insights. Bonisa is a South African data science and AI firm that combines credit bureau data with other data sources for credit scoring, fraud modelling and lending decisions. The stated plan is to sell decisioning as a service and take it into new markets. *Also under [AI](#) and [ICT Industry](#).*
- **Paymob raises \$35 million in pre-series C round co-led by Mubadala and EBRD to accelerate expansion in the MENA region** — Mubadala, 21 September 2026 EGYPT
Egyptian payments company Paymob raised \$35 million in a pre-Series C round co-led by Abu Dhabi's Mubadala and the EBRD, with BII, Global Ventures and DPI Ventures also taking part (21 September 2026). The money will fund expansion across the Middle East and North Africa. Paymob says revenue from the Gulf grew sevenfold in 18 months and now makes up close to half the total. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*
- **Mission Mobile secures R500m funding** — ITWeb, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Johannesburg start-up Mission Mobile, which finances smartphones and connectivity through operators' stores, says it has secured R500 million from DN Invest, drawn from DNI's own funds and dedicated debt facilities. The date of the commitment was not given. Its Beam platform uses data on how people earn and spend to offer phones to prepaid customers, who account for over 80% of South African mobile connections. *Also under [Access to services](#) and [Digital divides](#).*
- **Contrôle des finances publiques : l'IGF sollicite l'appui de l'AFD pour sa transformation digitale** — 7sur7.cd, 21 September 2026 DRC

DR Congo's Inspection Générale des Finances asked the French development agency AFD, at its Paris headquarters on 18 September 2026, to support its digital transformation. The plan centres on a national store of state financial data for auditing. The head of the DRC's digital transformation project said AFD could help through that project, but the talks were exploratory and no amount was named. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#) and [Data Storage](#).*

- **MPs BACK E1.14BN DIGITAL LOANS - Eswatini Positive News** — Eswatini Positive News, 21 September 2026

ESWATINI

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

- **E455m EPTC loan puts taxpayers on the line** — Independent News Eswatini, 21 September 2026

ESWATINI

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Profile - GAMTEL** — Gambia Telecommunications Company Limited (GAMTEL), 21 September 2026

GAMBIA

The Gambian state operator's undated company profile. It says Gamtel has four international gateways on the ACE submarine cable giving 25 Gbps, and a 28 Gbps backup link through Senegal's Free that traffic switches to if ACE fails.

- **Les entités sous tutelle — Ministère de la Transformation numérique, de l'Innovation et de la Modernisation de l'Administration** — Ministère de la Transformation numérique, de l'Innovation et de la Modernisation de l'Administration (MTNIMA), Mauritanie, 21 September 2026

MAURITANIA

Mauritania's digital ministry lists the bodies under its supervision: a distance-learning centre, the postal operator, and the state company that owns the national fibre backbone, created by decree in 2014, alongside the regional connectivity projects it runs. The page states each body's mandate but gives no budget, staffing or performance figures. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#) and [Training and skills](#).*

- **GSMA and PDAA Unveil Roadmap to Close Africa's Mobile Internet Usage Gap and Connect One Billion People by 2030** — GSMA, 21 September 2026

AFRICA

The GSMA and the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa launched a roadmap in New York on 21 September 2026 on how to reach 1 billion connected Africans by 2030. Based on 11 markets, it finds about 906 million people living within mobile broadband coverage but not using the mobile internet, against 122 million with no coverage at all. Its three priorities are moving over 600 million 2G and 3G connections to 4G or 5G, investing in energy and connectivity together, and reaching rural areas more cheaply. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

- **Ericsson Modernizes Vodafone Egypt's RAN with AI-Powered RAN Processor 6672** — Africa Telecom Review, 21 September 2026

EGYPT

Vodafone Egypt has started commercial rollout of Ericsson's AI-capable RAN Processor 6672, making Egypt one of the first markets after Japan. The unit runs AI at each radio site rather than centrally, and Ericsson claims it gives up to four times the processing capacity for less than half the energy. No number of sites, contract value or timetable was given. *Also under [AI](#).*

- **Advancing digital connectivity in Africa: Charting Africa's path to 1 billion connected people by 2030** — GSMA Intelligence for the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa (PDAA), 21 September 2026

AFRICA

The report behind the GSMA and PDAA roadmap, summarised under the launch. It counts 550 million internet users in Africa in 2025 (36% of the population) and projects about 700 million by 2030 on current trends. Halving the coverage and usage gaps could add some 514 million people and take the total past 1 billion. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

- **ACE Cable Selects Ciena for 30 Tb/s Upgrade** — Submarine Telecoms Forum, 21 September 2026

WEST AFRICA

The consortium behind the 17,000 km Africa Coast to Europe submarine cable has chosen Ciena's WaveLogic 6 Extreme optics to raise its total capacity above 30 Tb/s, Ciena said on 21 September 2026. The upgrade keeps the existing equipment at ACE's 18 landing stations, which serve more than 20 countries, and adds new transmission gear. No completion date was given.

- **Orange Egypt, Marakez pen partnership to deploy digital infrastructure across four developments** — ZAWYA, 21 September 2026

EGYPT

Summarised under [MoUs and other agreements](#).

- **Nigeria expanded broadband but missed its 70% penetration target** — BusinessDay NG, 21 September 2026

NIGERIA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

- **MPs BACK E1.14BN DIGITAL LOANS - Eswatini Positive News** — Eswatini Positive News, 21 September 2026

ESWATINI

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

- **Minister Solly Malatsi: National Digital Sovereignty Agenda** — South African Government (gov.za), 21 September 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

- **E455m EPTC loan puts taxpayers on the line** — Independent News Eswatini, 21 September 2026

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Data Storage

- **Governo quer acelerar transformação digital dos serviços públicos até 2029** — Agência de Informação de Moçambique (AIM), 21 September 2026

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- **Contrôle des finances publiques : l'IGF sollicite l'appui de l'AFD pour sa transformation digitale** — 7sur7.cd, 21 September 2026

DRC

Summarised under [New investments](#).

Cybersecurity

- **ABANC lança campanha contra fraude bancária** — ANGOP, 21 September 2026

ANGOLA

The Angolan Bankers Association launched a 60-day public campaign against banking fraud in Luanda on 21 September 2026, working with the interbank processor EMIS. Its president linked the campaign to the risks of banking by phone and to customers' low financial literacy. The campaign will appear in traditional and digital media, on billboards and ATMs, and through banks' own channels. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

- **Liberia's Cybercrime Law Faces Its First Real Trial as VP Koung case exposes Liberia's widening fault lines** — FrontPage Africa, 21 September 2026 LIBERIA
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).
- **Koung Seeks Release of AI Image Suspect** — The New Dawn Liberia, 21 September 2026 LIBERIA
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DPI

Data Exchange

- **Paula Ingabire Calls for Cross-Border Digital Systems to Accelerate Africa's Tech Transformation - Taarifa Rwanda** — Taarifa Rwanda, 21 September 2026 RWANDA
Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).
- **Minister Solly Malatsi: National Digital Sovereignty Agenda** — South African Government (gov.za), 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
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- **Governo quer acelerar transformação digital dos serviços públicos até 2029** — Agência de Informação de Moçambique (AIM), 21 September 2026 MOZAMBIQUE
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- **Governo Garante "Soberania do Estado" Sobre Dados Públicos** — Diário Económico, 21 September 2026 MOZAMBIQUE
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **Communiqué du Conseil des ministres** — Interfil Algérie, 21 September 2026 ALGERIA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Somalia Participates in Third Technical and Tactical ID-Control Training in Nairobi** — SONNA, 21 September 2026 SOMALIA
Officers from Somalia's identity authority, immigration agency and criminal investigation department are taking part in a joint course with Kenyan immigration in Nairobi from 21 to 25 September 2026. It is the third such course and covers document examination, identity checks and facial comparison. Norway's migration partnership supports it. *Also under [Training and skills](#)*.
- **MPs BACK E1.14BN DIGITAL LOANS - Eswatini Positive News** — Eswatini Positive News, 21 September 2026 ESWATINI
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **South Africa Online Shopping Lags Internet Access as Retail Market Targets Wider Adoption** — Tech Africa News, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

The Online Retail in South Africa 2026 report finds 79.1% of adults online but only 34.2% shopping online in 2025, down from 36.6% in 2024, while online retail turnover rose to about R130 billion. The gap is widest among lower-income consumers and women. Delivery costs, weak last-mile service outside the cities and worries about payment security are named as barriers. *Also under [Digital divides](#) and [ICT Industry](#).*

- **Orange Burkina Faso lance la nouvelle version de son application « Max It »** – Burkina24, 21 September 2026

BURKINA FASO

Orange Burkina Faso relaunched its Max It app on 18 September 2026 with a promotional caravan through four cities. The new version adds messaging and TV to mobile money, calls and SMS, and is open to customers of other networks. It links to almost all the country's banks for transfers to wallets, and takes water and electricity bills and public charges such as the vehicle tax.

- **Movimentos entre carteiras digitais valem apenas 0,6% no Kwik** – Expansão, 21 September 2026

ANGOLA

Transfers between digital wallets were only 0.6% (Kz 3.1 billion) of the Kz 557.4 billion that passed through Angola's Kwik instant-payment system in the first half of 2026, according to EMIS data. Wallets sent about 38% of the value, nearly all of it to bank accounts, while banks sent about 62%, and only Kz 2.8 billion of that went to non-bank providers. Only the free opening of the article is held. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

- **Local stablecoins are great, but who really needs them?** – TechCabal, 21 September 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

NIGERIA

TANZANIA

KENYA

AFRICA

An analysis arguing that stablecoins tied to African currencies have a weak case for retail use, because mobile money and bank transfers already work at home. It sees more promise in wholesale use and currency exchange on the blockchain. It gives supply as of 21 September 2026: about R74.6 million of ZARP in circulation and more than ₦3.75 billion of cNGN. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

- **Gasy Money: BGFIBank Madagascar réinvente le mobile banking** – Newsmada, 21 September 2026

MADAGASCAR

BGFIBank Madagascar launched Gasy Money, a mobile banking app open to people without an account at the bank, including those with no bank account at all, on any mobile network. The launch date was not given. It handles deposits and withdrawals through agents, branches and ATMs, merchant and bill payments, top-ups of prepaid Visa cards, and transfers to bank accounts and Airtel Money. *Also under [Access to services](#).*

- **Eswatini payment system enters new era** – Eswatini Observer, 21 September 2026

ESWATINI

The Central Bank of Eswatini says the fast-payments service of the Eswatini Payment Switch now links banks and mobile-money providers in real time at any hour, with QR-code payments to merchants being built next. Speaking at Tourism Nkwe 2026 in Mbabane, a deputy director said open banking and a domestic card switch will follow. Links to other countries come at a later stage.

- **Banque mondiale : le PAGDS présente ses réalisations dans la digitalisation des services publics** – Agence Ivoirienne de Presse (AIP), 21 September 2026

CÔTE D'IVOIRE

Côte d'Ivoire's World Bank-funded PAGDS project, approved in April 2019, reported its digitalisation results on 21 September 2026, and its coordinator said a second phase has started. The results include digital allocation and tracking of pupils in private schools, patient tracking under universal health coverage, electronic payment of state transfers and online company registration. World Bank figures cited put average growth in non-oil tax revenue at 12.4% against a 5% target, and customs revenue at 19.2% against 6%. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#) and [Access to services](#).*

- **Au Burkina Faso, l'assureur SONAR mise sur Orange Money pour numériser ses services** — wearetech.africa, 21 September 2026 BURKINA FASO
Insurer SONAR Assurance and Orange Money Burkina Faso signed a partnership in Ouagadougou on 18 September 2026 so clients can take out policies, pay premiums and check their contracts by phone. Orange Money says it has about 100,000 points of sale in the country. The exact terms of access have not yet been set.
- **Absa Botswana's Google Pay, Bringing contactless payments to a nation still reaching for them** — Weekend Post, 21 September 2026 BOTSWANA
Absa Bank Botswana has made Google Pay available on Android for its Visa debit, credit and multi-currency virtual cards, with no extra fees. The launch date was not given. The service only works where merchants have NFC terminals, and the report says these are patchy outside Gaborone and Francistown.
- **The National Payment System Bill, 2026 (draft for comment)** — The National Treasury / Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026 KENYA
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).
- **Paymob raises \$35 million in pre-series C round co-led by Mubadala and EBRD to accelerate expansion in the MENA region** — Mubadala, 21 September 2026 EGYPT
Summarised under [New investments](#).
- **EAC, PAPSS, IA : la BCC accélère l'intégration de la RDC dans l'écosystème financier africain** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026 DRC
Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).
- **Draft National Payment System Policy, August 2026** — The National Treasury, Republic of Kenya, 21 September 2026 KENYA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **Draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill, 2026** — Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026 KENYA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **Bank of Sudan's banking sector reform strategy faces range of challenges, led by digital transformation - Dabanga Radio TV Online** — Radio Dabanga, 21 September 2026 SUDAN
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **ABANC lança campanha contra fraude bancária** — ANGOP, 21 September 2026 ANGOLA
Summarised under [Cybersecurity](#).

Registries

- **Concern as Govt Land Platform Goes Down, Kenyans Face Service Disruption** — Kenyans.co.ke, 21 September 2026 KENYA
Kenya's ArdhiSasa land platform announced an outage on 21 September 2026 affecting searches, transfers, title and lease registration, and stamp duty and land-rent payments, with no time given for restoring service. The Law Society of Kenya had already complained that the platform was unavailable from 1 September. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#)*.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **«المركزي» يبحث إنشاء منظومة إلكترونية وقاعدة بيانات موحدة للدول»** — بوابة الوسط, 21 September 2026 LIBYA
Libya's central bank governor, Naji Issa, put forward an electronic system and a single national database for recording and following up international grants, projects and support. He made the proposal on 21 September 2026 at the second meeting of the committee set up under prime-ministerial decision 422 of 2026. The idea is still under discussion and has not been adopted.
- **New Sita boss vows to rebuild trust after governance failures** — Business Day, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **MPs BACK E1.14BN DIGITAL LOANS - Eswatini Positive News** — Eswatini Positive News, 21 September 2026 ESWATINI
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).
- **Minister Solly Malatsi: National Digital Sovereignty Agenda** — South African Government (gov.za), 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **LRA to Provide Technical Support for Gambia's Revenue Collection Dashboard** — Global News Network Liberia, 21 September 2026 GAMBIA LIBERIA
Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).
- **Les entités sous tutelle — Ministère de la Transformation numérique, de l'Innovation et de la Modernisation de l'Administration** — Ministère de la Transformation numérique, de l'Innovation et de la Modernisation de l'Administration (MTNIMA), Mauritanie, 21 September 2026 MAURITANIA
Summarised under [Connectivity](#).
- **GRA and Liberia Revenue Authority sign deal to deepen digital cooperation** — The Point, 21 September 2026 GAMBIA LIBERIA
Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).
- **Governo quer acelerar transformação digital dos serviços públicos até 2029** — Agência de Informação de Moçambique (AIM), 21 September 2026 MOZAMBIQUE
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **Governo Garante “Soberania do Estado” Sobre Dados Públicos** — Diário Económico, 21 September 2026 MOZAMBIQUE
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **E455m EPTC loan puts taxpayers on the line** — Independent News Eswatini, 21 September 2026 ESWATINI
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).
- **Contrôle des finances publiques : l'IGF sollicite l'appui de l'AFD pour sa transformation digitale** — 7sur7.cd, 21 September 2026 DRC
Summarised under [New investments](#).

- **Concern as Govt Land Platform Goes Down, Kenyans Face Service Disruption** — Kenyans.co.ke, 21 September 2026 KENYA
Summarised under [Registries](#).
- **Banque mondiale : le PAGDS présente ses réalisations dans la digitalisation des services publics** — Agence Ivoirienne de Presse (AIP), 21 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE
Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).

Technology

AI

- **Nouvelles technologies : Le Mali se dote d'un centre d'intelligence artificielle et de robotique** — Burkina24, 21 September 2026 MALI
Transition president Assimi Goïta opened Mali's artificial intelligence and robotics centre, CIAR-Mali, at Kati on 21 September 2026. He had laid its foundation stone on 7 June 2023. The 50-hectare site has six buildings, including teaching space, dormitories and a workshop for building intelligent systems, and cost FCFA 3.3 billion, all from the national budget. *Also under [Research institutions](#).*
- **We co-led the UN's dialogue on safe and secure AI. Here's what needs to happen now** — Fortune, 21 September 2026 GLOBAL
Summarised under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).
- **VEA Capital Partners Backs Bonisa Applied Insights To Unlock Data-Driven Value Globally** — Africa Tech Summit, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [New investments](#).
- **SIERRA LEONE'S NATIONAL AI STRATEGY SHOULD SET AUTHORITY LIMITS FOR AGENTS** — The Calabash Newspaper, 21 September 2026 SIERRA LEONE
Summarised under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).
- **Sicom 2026 : un bilan et des engagements pour l'avenir** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 21 September 2026 CONGO
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).
- **Kenya, Hoover Institution sign AI data pact** — ITWeb Africa, 21 September 2026 KENYA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **FPB plans AI-powered oversight of streaming, social platforms** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).
- **Ericsson Modernizes Vodafone Egypt's RAN with AI-Powered RAN Processor 6672** — Africa Telecom Review, 21 September 2026 EGYPT
Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

- **EAC, PAPSS, IA : la BCC accélère l'intégration de la RDC dans l'écosystème financier africain** — Actualite.cd, 21 September 2026 DRC
Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

ICT Industry

- **Terms of Reference: Consultancy Services for Establishment of a National Business Process Outsourcing (BPO) for High-Value IT-Enabled Services Industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative (OTNI) — Investment in Digital and Creative Enterprises (iDICE) Programme** — Bank of Industry (BOI), iDICE Programme Coordination Unit, 21 September 2026 NIGERIA
The terms of reference, dated 21 September 2026, for the iDICE consultancy to build a knowledge-process outsourcing industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative. They set five workstreams and a target of paid placement for 80% of trainees within six months. The procurement is summarised under the Premium Times notice. *Also under [Training and skills](#).*
- **Request for Expression of Interest- Consultancy Services for the Establishment of a National Business Process Outsourcing and High-Value IT-Enabled Services Industry for the iDICE Programme** — Premium Times (notice by the iDICE Programme Coordination Unit, Bank of Industry), 21 September 2026 NIGERIA
Nigeria's Bank of Industry, which runs the iDICE programme, is seeking consultants for a 16-month assignment to build a knowledge-process outsourcing industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative. The brief includes an academy for 1,000 graduates, 200 paid residency places a year, a target of 80% placement within six months of certification, and a framework of rules and tax incentives for delivery centres. iDICE is co-financed by the AfDB, AFD and IsDB; expressions of interest close on 5 October 2026. *Also under [Training and skills](#).*
- **VEA Capital Partners Backs Bonisa Applied Insights To Unlock Data-Driven Value Globally** — Africa Tech Summit, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [New investments](#).
- **South Africa Online Shopping Lags Internet Access as Retail Market Targets Wider Adoption** — Tech Africa News, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).

Innovation ecosystem

- **Malawi, India deepen tech ties** — ITWeb Africa, 21 September 2026 MALAWI
India's High Commission and the mHub innovation hub held a workshop in Lilongwe on AI, digital skills and technology investment, attended by more than 70 companies. India's high commissioner pointed to openings in agriculture, digital public infrastructure and financial inclusion. No agreement or commitment came out of it. *Also under [India activities](#).*
- **Local stablecoins are great, but who really needs them?** — TechCabal, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
NIGERIA TANZANIA KENYA AFRICA
Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).
- **Fintech will drive jobs, economic growth – Namfisa** — New Era, 21 September 2026 NAMIBIA
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Capacity

Training and skills

- **Egypt's NTI Partners With 4DT.io to Train Youth in Digital Transformation and Automation** — Tech Africa News, 21 September 2026 EGYPT
Egypt's National Telecommunications Institute agreed with digital-twin and automation firm 4DT.io, in Cairo on 19 September 2026, to train young people in digital transformation and automation. The programmes will mix classroom teaching, hands-on training and project work. No intake, length, cost or certification was stated.
- **Terms of Reference: Consultancy Services for Establishment of a National Business Process Outsourcing (BPO) for High-Value IT-Enabled Services Industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative (OTNI) — Investment in Digital and Creative Enterprises (iDICE) Programme** — Bank of Industry (BOI), iDICE Programme Coordination Unit, 21 September 2026 NIGERIA
Summarised under [ICT Industry](#).
- **Somalia Participates in Third Technical and Tactical ID-Control Training in Nairobi** — SONNA, 21 September 2026 SOMALIA
Summarised under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#).
- **Request for Expression of Interest- Consultancy Services for the Establishment of a National Business Process Outsourcing and High-Value IT-Enabled Services Industry for the iDICE Programme** — Premium Times (notice by the iDICE Programme Coordination Unit, Bank of Industry), 21 September 2026 NIGERIA
Summarised under [ICT Industry](#).
- **Les entités sous tutelle — Ministère de la Transformation numérique, de l'Innovation et de la Modernisation de l'Administration** — Ministère de la Transformation numérique, de l'Innovation et de la Modernisation de l'Administration (MTNIMA), Mauritanie, 21 September 2026 MAURITANIA
Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

Research institutions

- **Nouvelles technologies : Le Mali se dote d'un centre d'intelligence artificielle et de robotique** — Burkina24, 21 September 2026 MALI
Summarised under [AI](#).

Inclusion

Access to services

- **Nigeria's new phone registry threatens rising smartphone prices** — TechCabal, 21 September 2026 NIGERIA
Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **Movimentos entre carteiras digitais valem apenas 0,6% no Kwik** — Expansão, 21 September 2026 ANGOLA
Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).
- **Mission Mobile secures R500m funding** — ITWeb, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [New investments](#).

- **GSMA and PDAA Unveil Roadmap to Close Africa's Mobile Internet Usage Gap and Connect One Billion People by 2030** — GSMA, 21 September 2026 AFRICA
Summarised under [Connectivity](#).
- **Gasy Money: BGFIBank Madagascar réinvente le mobile banking** — Newsmada, 21 September 2026 MADAGASCAR
Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).
- **Fintech will drive jobs, economic growth – Namfisa** — New Era, 21 September 2026 NAMIBIA
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).
- **Banque mondiale : le PAGDS présente ses réalisations dans la digitalisation des services publics** — Agence Ivoirienne de Presse (AIP), 21 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE
Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).
- **Advancing digital connectivity in Africa: Charting Africa's path to 1 billion connected people by 2030** — GSMA Intelligence for the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa (PDAA), 21 September 2026 AFRICA
Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

Digital divides

- **South Africa Online Shopping Lags Internet Access as Retail Market Targets Wider Adoption** — Tech Africa News, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).
- **Mission Mobile secures R500m funding** — ITWeb, 21 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
Summarised under [New investments](#).
- **Evaluating Government Policies and Interventions in Advancing Digital Inclusion in Rural Nigeria - NALTF** — National Assembly Library Trust Fund, 21 September 2026 NIGERIA
Summarised under [Public debate and participation in policymaking](#).

Data

Open data

- **The National Payment System Bill, 2026 (draft for comment)** — The National Treasury / Central Bank of Kenya, 21 September 2026 KENYA
Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Geopolitics

India activities

- **India, Egypt Discuss Deeper ICT and Communications Cooperation** — NewKerala (IANS), 21 September 2026 EGYPT

India's ambassador to Egypt, Suresh Reddy, met communications minister Raafat Hindy to discuss closer cooperation on ICT. According to the Indian embassy, the talks covered India's digital public infrastructure and how it could be used elsewhere, cooperation between institutions, and links between the two countries' tech companies. No outcome was announced.

- **Malawi, India deepen tech ties** — ITWeb Africa, 21 September 2026

MALAWI

Summarised under [Innovation ecosystem](#).

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